User Guide

CineBrain Pro 1.0 · PDF version

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1 · Getting started

CineBrain Pro is an exposure and depth-of-field wheel for photography and cinema, a director’s viewfinder that shows your lens’s frame through the iPhone camera, a light meter, a gel and filter calculator, and a scout archive with a light plan for every frame you save.

First launch

Three cards show what the app does, what is free and what Pro adds. They appear once; tap **Skip** to leave at any time. You can watch them again in **Project Setup › Introduction**.

Free and Pro

The app is free to download. The exposure wheel, depth of field, and the camera and lens calculations are free, with no limits. The viewfinder, Zone (spot metering on the Zone System), light plan, scout PDFs and kits are fully open too, in one project at a time. When you create a second project, the Pro screen opens: **CineBrain Pro** is a one-time purchase (no subscription) that removes the limit. The price comes from the App Store. **Restore purchases** on the Pro screen and in **Project Setup › CineBrain Pro** brings Pro back on a new iPhone with the same Apple Account. Pro is checked on your iPhone, so it works offline. If you already had several projects before Pro, they stay: you can open them, switch between them and make PDFs; only a new project needs Pro.

Tips

Short tips appear once, the first time you open a screen: turning the wheel’s rings, picking a lens and reading the Open Gate and Protection frames in the viewfinder, measuring points with Zone (up to 5; the first is the key, Zone V), where a frame’s heading comes from (point the phone where the camera will look before you save) and making a PDF in the archive. Close a tip with ×. **Project Setup › Introduction › Show tips again** shows each of them once more.

Help on every screen

The small **?** at the top right of each main screen — the wheel, the viewfinder, the archive, frame details, Color and Project Setup — darkens the screen and puts short labels next to the controls. Tap anywhere to close it. **Full help** at the bottom opens a

short explanation with three to five steps and a **Full guide** link to the matching part of this page.

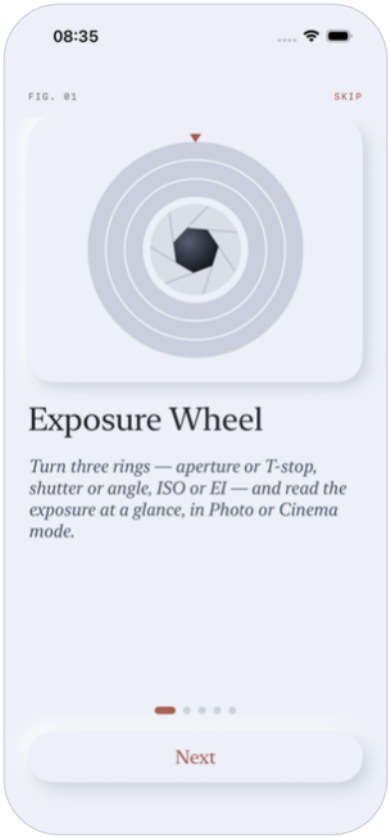
Permissions

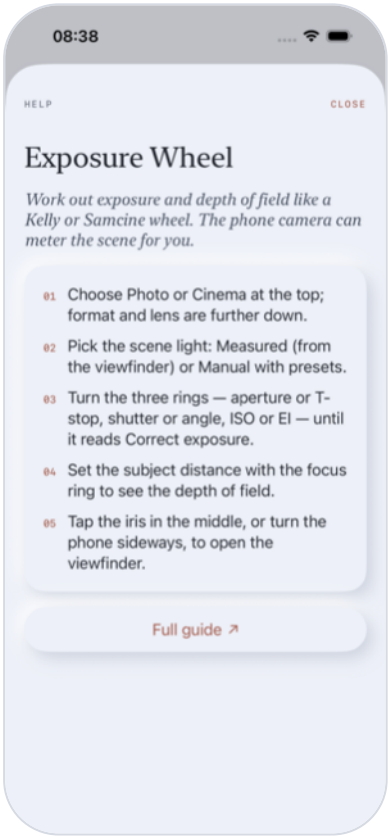
- **Camera** — the viewfinder, metering and saving frames.
- **Location, while using the app** — the sun's position and light times. Optional.
- **Photos, add only** — saving frames to your photo library.
- **Microphone and Speech Recognition** — asked the first time you hold a note's microphone; only for voice notes, recognized on your iPhone. Optional.

LiDAR, compass and motion sensors need no permission. Nothing leaves your iPhone; see the privacy policy.

Language and units

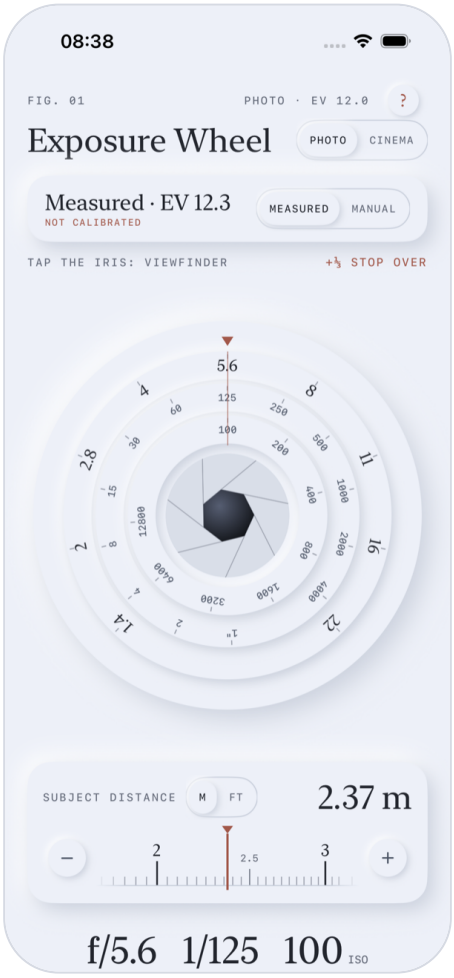
The app follows your iPhone's language (English or Turkish); you can choose a different one for this app alone in **Settings › CineBrain Pro › Language**. Distances use meters or feet according to your region; switch in the subject distance card or in Project Setup.





FIELD NOTES

2 · Exposure Wheel



EXPOSURE WHEEL

Photo or Cinema

The switch next to the title changes the wheel. The app opens in Cinema the first time and then in whichever mode you used last; each mode remembers its own format, frame rate, filters, shutter and ISO. **Photo** uses f-stops, shutter speeds (1 s to 1/4000) and ISO. **Cinema** uses T-stops, shutter angle (360° to 11.25°) with a frame rate, and EI. Switching resets shutter and sensitivity to sensible defaults (1/125 · ISO 100, or 180° · EI 800 with ND 0.9) and sets the aperture to match the scene.

Scene light

- **Measured** — read by the iPhone camera while the viewfinder is open. The wheel keeps the last reading when you close it.
- **Manual** — choose Sunny (EV 15), Overcast (12), Indoor (8) or Night (5).
- **Spot** appears after you use “Expose for this point” in the viewfinder.

The small **not calibrated** note opens the meter calibration (see Project Setup). Under the card, the wheel tells you how far the current settings are from correct exposure, in thirds of a stop: *+⅓ over*, *−1 under* or *correct*; the viewfinder shows the same next to the EV. Until the first reading comes in it shows "—".

The rings

Drag the rings round: outer — aperture or T-stop (1.4 to 22); middle — shutter or angle; inner — ISO or EI (100 to 12800). Aperture, ISO/EI and the Photo shutter (1″, 0.8″, 0.6″, 1/2 … 1/4000) move in thirds of a stop: full stops are numbered on the ring and thirds are small ticks (the selected tick is copper); the full label of the selected value (e.g. *T3.2*, *1280 EI*) is shown above the wheel. A third gives a light tap, a full stop a firmer click; turning one full stop takes as much as before. The shutter angle list (360° to 11.25°) is unchanged. With an ARRI camera chosen in Cinema (see Camera and recording mode), the EI ring uses ARRI's list: 160, 200, 250, 320, 400, 500, 640, 800, 1000, 1280, 1600, 2000, 2560, 3200, 4800, 6400; Sony, RED and the generic formats use 100 to 12800 in thirds. The labels are the usual rounded values; the calculations use the exact ones (T2.8 is 2.83, T22 is 22.63; EI 1280 counts the same as 1250), so depth of field at full stops can differ from earlier versions by up to 3%. Tap the iris in the middle, or turn the phone sideways, to open the viewfinder. The EV at the top right is the EV of the current settings, filters included.

Below the wheel

- The **filters** line (when filters are mounted) and the **subject distance** card — see Focus.
- Aperture, shutter and ISO in large type, then the **depth of field** card: near and far limits, hyperfocal distance, sensor size, crop factor, circle of confusion and the lens's approximate horizontal angle of view at the current focus distance, and the frame's approximate width × height at the focus distance (e.g. "Frame at 3.00 m: ≈1.44 × 0.60 m"). The viewfinder shows the same size under the active frame's label and the circle of confusion next to the depth of field ("Sharp 2.77–3.27 m · CoC 0.025").
- The **color temperature** card opens Color.
- **Format** — Photo: Micro 4/3, APS-C, Full frame, Medium format. Cinema: Super 16, Super 35, Full Frame (35.9 × 24 mm), Large format, 65 mm. **Frame rate** (Cinema): 24 to 120.
- **Filters** — add with *+ Add filter*: ND 0.3–2.1, polarizer (≈1⅔ stops), 85 and 85B (⅔), 80A (2), 81A (⅓), diffusion ⅛–1 (no light loss) or a custom loss in stops. Tap a filter to remove it. The total loss counts in the exposure.

- **Lens** — 8 to 600 mm.
- **Set aperture for the scene** picks the aperture or T-stop closest to correct exposure, to the nearest third of a stop.

FIELD NOTES

3 · Focus and depth of field

The focus ring

The subject distance card works like a lens focus scale: drag the ruler left or right under the copper index. The scale is logarithmic — close distances are spread out, far ones bunched up. Drag slowly for fine steps, fast to move quickly. Each step gives a light tap; whole meters or feet give a firmer click. Dragging the ruler never scrolls the page.

Steps (meters)
1 cm up to 2 m · 5 cm from 2 to 5 m · 10 cm from 5 to 10 m · 50 cm from 10 to 30 m · then ∞.

Steps (feet)
1″ up to 6′6″ · 2″ up to 16′6″ · 4″ up to 33′ · 1′6″ up to 100′ · then ∞.
The **– / +** buttons move one step of the current range; hold them to repeat, faster the longer you hold. Tap the large value to type an exact distance (for example 2.37 m, or feet and inches), or choose ∞. The **m / ft** switch changes the unit.

In the viewfinder

The same distance appears in the viewfinder under **Focus** (tap it in the value strip), and the iPhone camera focuses at about that distance. On iPhones with LiDAR, **Measure distance** — the round button with a crosshair at the end of the focus ring — measures the point in the center of the frame (up to about 5 m) and writes it in. iPhones with two rear cameras show **Estimate distance** instead, worked out from the depth data of the two cameras. On iPhones with one rear camera there is no button; set the distance by hand. In short: LiDAR on LiDAR models; an approximate estimate from depth on dual-camera models; manual entry on other models. Estimates are marked ≈ here, in the viewfinder and in the frame's details. In every case the *Distance measuring offset* in Project Setup is added for the distance between phone and sensor plane.

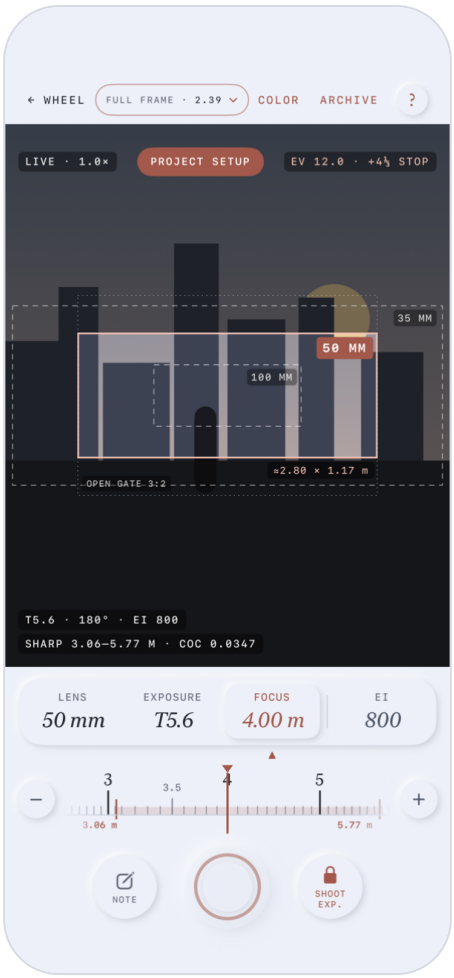
Depth of field

Depth of field uses the circle of confusion of the chosen format and is shown to the centimeter below 10 m (for example 2.31–2.48 m), or in feet and inches.

The circle of confusion is an assumption; it has no single correct value, and the standard you choose changes the result. CineBrain works out hyperfocal distance and depth of field with the circle of confusion on the sensor; it does not take print or screen enlargement into account.

Depth-of-field marks on the ring

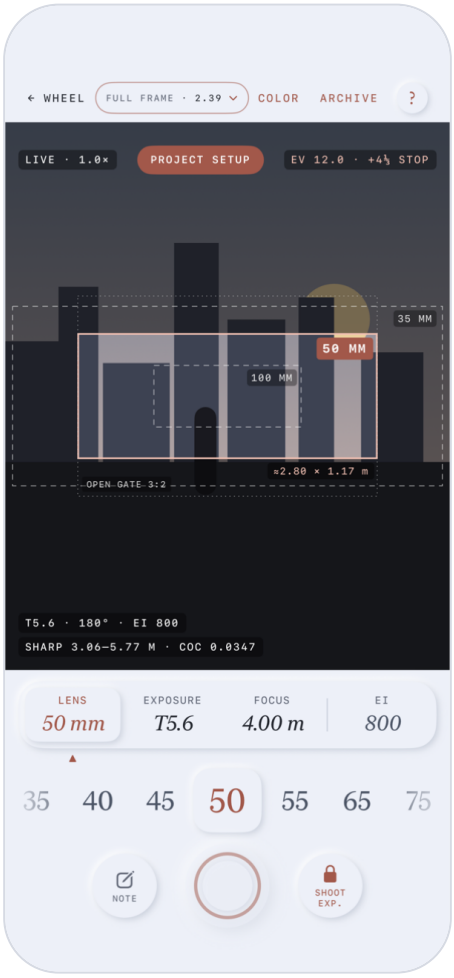
Like the depth-of-field scale on a lens barrel, the focus ring shows two short copper lines on either side of the index: the near and far limits of sharpness for the current lens, aperture or T-stop, format and distance. The space between them is lightly filled, and the limits are written beside the lines in small mono type (to the centimeter below 10 m, or in feet and inches). When the far limit reaches infinity — you are focused at or beyond the hyperfocal distance — the band runs with an arrow to the ∞ end instead of a far line. If a limit is off the visible part of the ring, its value waits at the edge with an arrow. The marks follow the logarithmic scale and update as soon as you change the lens, aperture, format or distance; in the viewfinder they use the aperture chosen under Exposure.



VIEWFINDER · FOCUS

FIELD NOTES

4 · Viewfinder



VIEWFINDER · FULL FRAME 2.39 · OPEN GATE 3:2

What you see

The iPhone camera zooms so that the active lens's frame (copper, in the chosen aspect ratio) and its protect lines fill the picture — almost edge to edge in landscape, full width in portrait. The iPhone switches between its ultra-wide, wide and telephoto cameras by itself. Outside the frame is darkened; neighboring lenses are drawn as dashed frames with their focal lengths. A dotted line shows the whole format — the **open gate**, from the format's recorded width × height (e.g. *Open gate 3:2* for Full Frame 35.9 × 24 mm); the chosen ratio sits centered inside it and never goes beyond it. Under the active frame's label, *≈2.80 × 1.17 m* is the frame's size at the focus distance, in the chosen ratio; if it would cover another label it moves below or inside the frame. If your lens is wider than the phone can show, ◂ **Wider** ▸ appears.

Top of the screen

- **← Wheel**, the format label, **Color**, **Archive** and **?**. The format label shows the sensor format, the ratio, the anamorphic squeeze and how many protect ratios are on (e.g. *Super 35 · 2.39 · 2× · +2*). It sits in a capsule with a copper outline and a small arrow; tap it to change them.
- **Live · 1.4×** — the phone's zoom (1× = main camera).
- The copper **scene · shot** button (**Project Setup** when there is no project) — opens Project Setup.
- **EV · stops** — the scene light and how far the settings are from correct exposure.

Bottom of the screen

- **Value strip** — **Lens · Exposure · Focus** and, after a thin divider, **EI** (or ISO; display only). Tap a value to change it: the selected one is raised and copper with a small copper arrow under it, and the picker below switches to it.
- **Lens** — the picker lists the focal lengths (of the lens pack, if one is chosen); the selected one sits in a raised copper box and the others fade toward the edges. If yours isn't in the list, **Custom…** at the end takes any value from 1 to 2000 mm, decimals too (52.3 or 52,3); it is remembered with the mode's settings.
- **Exposure** — choose an aperture or T-stop to preview: the picture brightens or darkens to show the over- or underexposure. The frame you save records this value.
- **Focus** — the focus ring with – / +, and at its end a round crosshair button: **Measure distance** (LiDAR) or **Estimate distance** (dual-camera iPhones; none on single-camera iPhones, see Focus).
- **Action row** — the shutter in the middle, **Note** on the left and the saved-exposure switch on the right (a closed lock for **Shoot exp.**, an open lock for **Normal exp.**), the same size and the same distance from the shutter.

Format, aspect ratio and anamorphic

The first time you open the viewfinder in a mode, it asks **Which format does your camera record in?** and lists that mode's formats with their sensor sizes (e.g. Super 35 · 24.89 × 18.66 mm). Tap yours. Photo and Cinema are asked separately, since each mode keeps its own format. Once you have picked a format here, on the wheel or in Project Setup, the question doesn't come back; if you swipe it away without choosing, it asks again next time.

Tap the format label (in landscape, the ratio on the rail) to open **Format & Ratio**:

- **Format** — the sensor format of the current mode (Photo or Cinema). In the lens list, pick the focal length engraved on your lens: everywhere in the app (viewfinder, wheel, archive, PDF) the lens is its real focal length, never a 35 mm equivalent; the angle of view is worked out from it and the format. Focusing closer narrows the frame a little: the viewfinder frame, the saved frame and the angle follow the focus distance (a thin-lens estimate — with a 50 mm about 3% narrower at 3 m, 10% at 1 m, 21% at 0.5 m). Real lenses "breathe" differently, so treat it as approximate.
- **Aspect ratio** — 1.33 (4:3), 1.66, 1.78 (16:9), 1.85, 2.00, 2.20, 2.39, 1:1, and 4:5 and 9:16 for vertical social video, or **Custom** (0.50–3.00 in steps of 0.01). The frame is the largest area of that ratio that fits the sensor: a ratio wider than the sensor is cut from the top and bottom, a narrower one from the sides. The horizontal angle of view and the frame lines follow from it.
- **Anamorphic squeeze** — Spherical, 1.3×, 1.5×, 1.8× or 2×. With an anamorphic lens the horizontal angle widens by the squeeze; the frame and angle of view are worked out on the desqueezed picture, and the chosen ratio is the ratio of the desqueezed picture.
- **Protect** — up to two extra ratios for shoot & protect (e.g. 16:9 for TV and 9:16 for social). Each is the largest area of that ratio on the sensor, drawn as a thin dashed line with a small label in its top-left corner.

The ratio, squeeze and protect lines you pick here last **only for this session**: Project Setup keeps its own value (shown at the top of the panel). **Back to Project Setup** drops the change; **Save to Project Setup** makes it the new setting. The format is the same setting as on the wheel and in Project Setup.

Spot metering

Tap anywhere in the picture to meter that point; a ring and its EV appear. **Expose for this point** makes it the scene light (source Spot) and sets the wheel's aperture to match. × returns to average metering.

Zone

Tap **Zone** (top left of the picture) to measure up to five points of the scene, one after another. Each tap meters that point with the phone's auto exposure and waits until it settles (a small spinner shows on the point); the value is the median of the readings over half a second. If it hasn't settled after 3 seconds, the last reading is used and marked ≈. On iOS 26 and later, where the phone supports it, a small metering rectangle is used and its angle is shown as *Spot ≈ 4°*; on earlier systems the angle can't be read, so it says *Spot ≈ ?*.

- **Zones from your exposure** — each point's Zone comes from the exposure you have set (aperture or T-stop, shutter or angle with the frame rate, ISO or EI, ND and filters): a point as bright as that exposure's mid grey is Zone V, one stop brighter Zone VI (1 stop = 1 Zone, to the nearest third). Change the aperture or EI and every point moves along the thin Zone scale (0–X) on the right edge, together with the B&W / Zone preview. Zones II–VIII — the range that still holds texture — are marked on the scale; points outside it say **No texture**.
- **Key** — the first point is the key. Tap a point to make it the key or, on the key, to choose the Zone you want it on (0–X, default V); hold a point to delete it; **Clear** removes them all.
- **Differences** — next to each point: its number and its difference from the key in stops, rounded to the nearest third (*2 · +1⅔*); the full value is used for the calculations.
- **SBR** — the brightest minus the darkest point, from the values shown (rounded to ⅓ stop, so the numbers agree), against the target in Project Setup (default 7 stops): *SBR 6⅓ · Target 7*. The verdict has three cases: above the target, *x stop over the target* (copper); within the target but with points outside Zones II–VIII (zone value 1.5–8.5), *SBR fits · n points outside the textured range* and a suggestion from your exposure — the smallest shift in ⅓ stops that brings every point inside, e.g. *Open up ⅓ stop: all points inside II–VIII* (or *Stop down*); otherwise *fits the range*. When the aperture allows it, **Apply** next to the suggestion sets the aperture or T-stop that much (in the viewfinder and on the wheel), and the verdict then reads *fits the range*. The same verdict appears in the PDF.
- **Expose for key** — sets the scene light so the key lands on its Zone: scene EV = key EV − (key Zone − 5), then picks the nearest third-stop aperture, so the key ends up within ⅙ stop of its Zone and the meter reads *correct*. Skin placed on Zone VI gets one stop more exposure.

Closing Zone returns the camera to its previous metering. A frame saved with Zone on keeps the points, the key and its Zone, the SBR, the target, the calibration and the spot angle; the frame details, the PDF and the copy in Photos show the numbered points, a Zone summary and the SBR. Their Zones are worked out from the frame's own saved exposure.

The phone's meter is accurate to about ⅓ stop. Differences are not affected by calibration; for absolute values, set Meter calibration against a reference light meter.

B&W and Zone preview

B&W, next to Zone, shows the picture in black and white as your set exposure would print it: the exposure's mid grey (18% grey) is Zone V, one stop is one Zone, with deep black at the bottom and white at the top on a soft curve, without steps. When it is on, the button becomes **B&W | ZONE**: tap **ZONE** for the stepped view, where every part of the picture takes the grey of its nearest whole Zone (0 black, V mid grey, X white; clipped highlights are Zone X), and tap the selected part to turn the preview off. It always starts in B&W. Change the aperture, shutter, EI or filters and the tones move; when the phone changes its own exposure (pointing at a brighter or darker place), the Zone of a surface stays where it is. The Zone strip in the PDF uses the same greys.

The preview is approximate: the live picture comes from the phone's processed image, so Zones are approximate — use the Zone points (spot metering) for exact readings. The same note is in the **?** labels. While the preview is on, the phone uses a single tone curve where it supports one; where it doesn't, the button shows **≈**. Frames saved with the preview on are saved in color, but without the phone's multi-frame processing, so they can look a little noisier or flatter.

Sun marker

With location and compass, a copper disc shows where the sun is in the picture, or an arrow at the edge points to it (kept clear of the info lines at the top and bottom). **Backlight** appears when the sun is inside the frame. If the marker is off, center the real sun horizontally and tap **Align** next to it; fine-tune in Project Setup › Compass correction.

Saving a frame

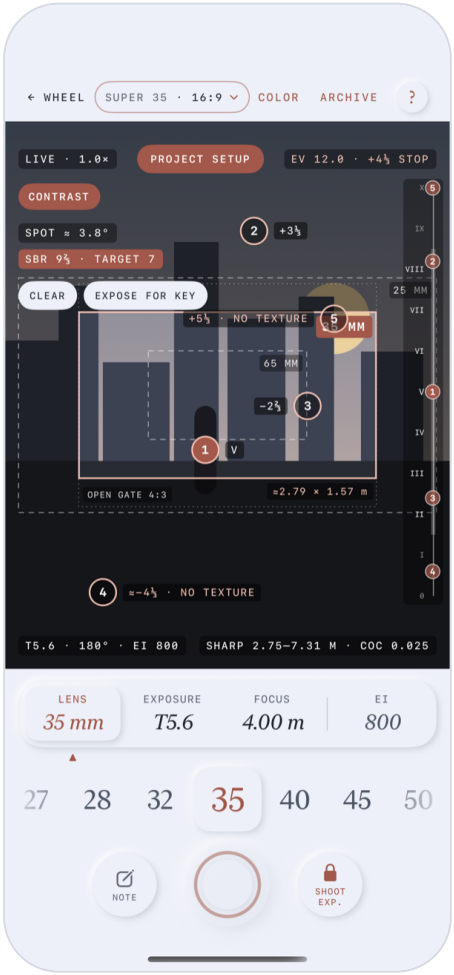
Press the round copper shutter. The screen flashes and "Saved · Scene 12 · Shot 3" appears. The frame is cropped to the active lens's frame in the chosen ratio and saved in the archive with the lens, format, aspect ratio, anamorphic squeeze, protect ratios, exposure, filters, focus distance, depth of field, date, project, day, scene and shot, and — when available — location and compass heading. It is also added to Photos, with an info strip below it if you turned that on. With "Advance the shot number with each frame", the shot number goes up by one. The **Note** button left of the shutter (on the right-hand rail when the phone is sideways) is always there: it opens the note of the last saved frame, to write or dictate (see Voice notes).

The round button right of the shutter (on the rail in landscape) chooses the exposure of the saved frame: **Shoot exp.** (closed lock, default) keeps the simulated exposure you see in the viewfinder, so an underexposed setting is saved dark; **Normal exp.**

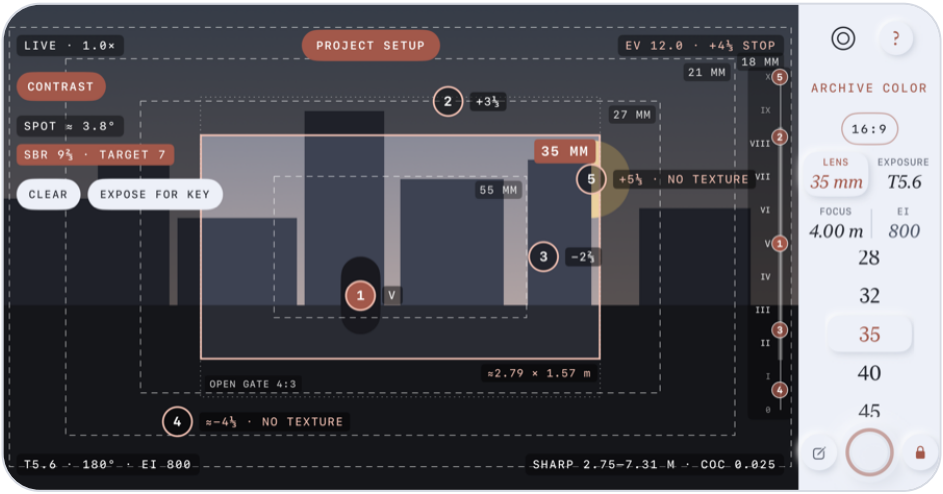
(open lock) lets the phone expose correctly for a moment before saving — good for recording the framing and the location. The frame's details show which one was used (*Saved exposure*).

Protect ratios are drawn on the saved frame as thin dashed lines with a small label — in the frame details, the PDF and the copy in Photos. A protect area larger than the frame shows only the lines that fall inside it (e.g. the sides of 9:16 on a 2.39 frame). Turn this off in Project Setup › Export.

Turn the phone sideways for the landscape layout: the controls move to a rail on the right with the same layout — the values in a 2 × 2 grid (Lens · Exposure / Focus · EI), the picker, and Note · shutter · saved exposure at the bottom (icons only) — and Focus shows a vertical focus ring (∞ at the top) with the same depth-of-field marks and – / + buttons.



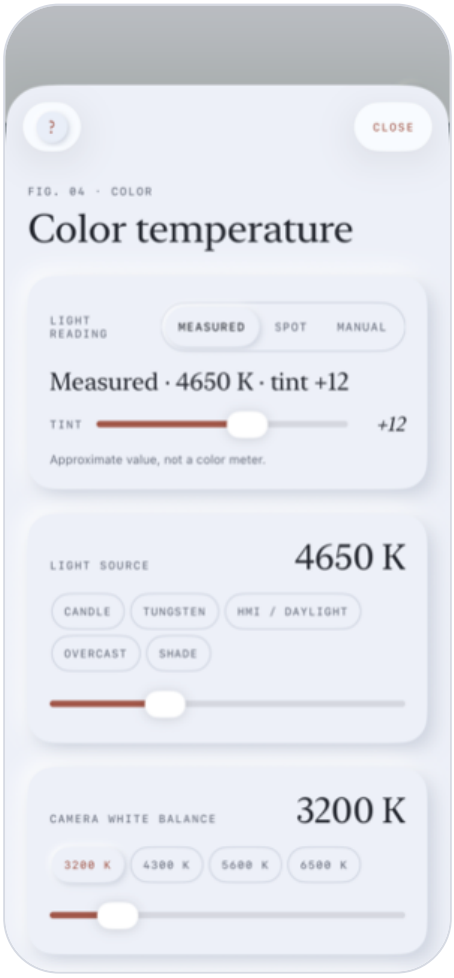
VIEWFINDER · ZONE



VIEWFINDER · ZONE, LANDSCAPE

FIELD NOTES

5 · Color



COLOR TEMPERATURE

Open **Color** from the color temperature card on the wheel or from the viewfinder.

Light reading

- **Measured** — the iPhone camera's automatic white balance, read live while the viewfinder runs.
- **Spot** — the viewfinder opens with "Tap a white or grey surface"; the color of that spot is measured and sent back here.
- **Manual** — Candle 1900 K, Tungsten 3200 K, HMI / Daylight 5600 K, Overcast 6500 K, Shade 7500 K, or the slider (1500–12000 K). Changing a value by hand switches the source to Manual.

The tint slider (−50 to +50) can be adjusted by hand. The reading is approximate — the phone is not a color meter.

Camera and mired shift

Set the camera’s white balance (3200, 4300, 5600, 6500 K or the slider). The mired shift is camera minus light: plus means the light is too blue (warm it with CTO), minus means it is too warm (cool it with CTB).

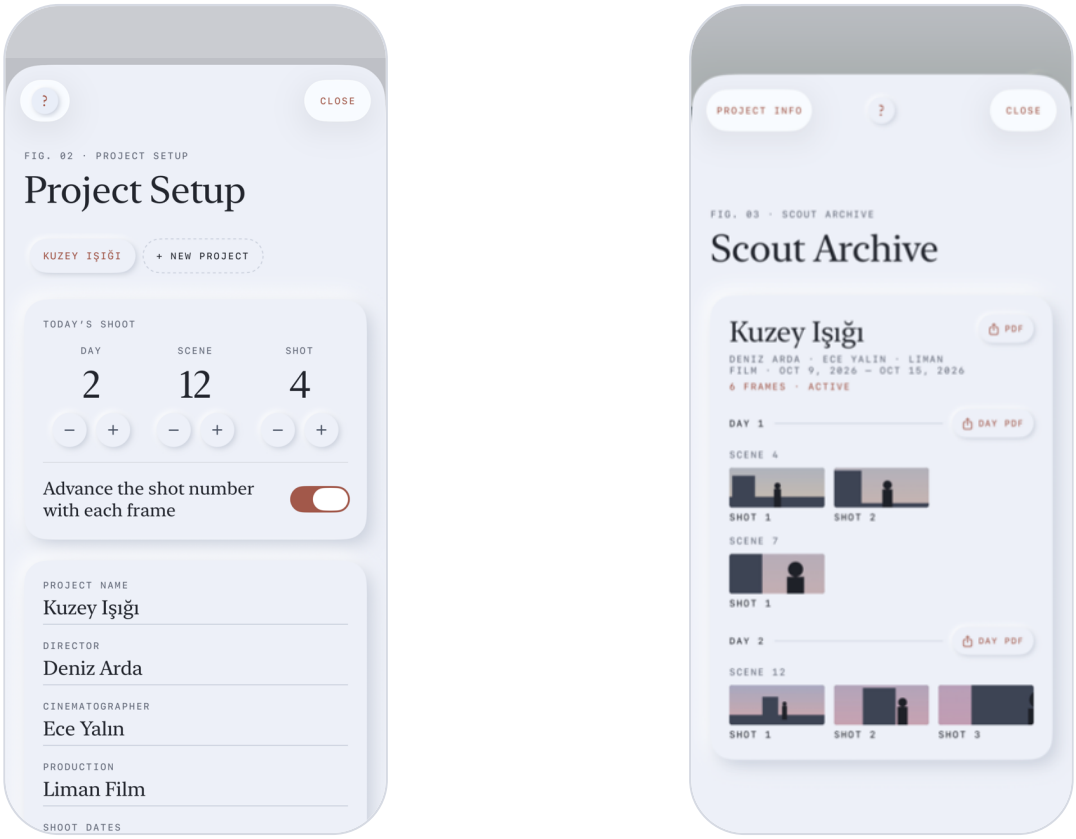
Suggestions

- **Gels on the light** — Rosco or LEE, one gel or a pair, with product numbers, the shift, what remains and the resulting color temperature.
- **Or a filter on the lens** — 85, 85B, 85C, 81A–C, 80A–C, 82A with their filter factors. **Mount on the lens** adds 85, 85B, 80A or 81A to the wheel’s filters.
- **Green · magenta** — from the tint: Plus or Minus Green, full, ½ or ¼ (Rosco 3304/3315/3316 and 3308/3313/3314; LEE 244–246 and 247–249). Tint is roughly in CC units.

Rosco values are as published. LEE publishes conversions; its mired shifts here are calculated from them. Camera filters use Wratten values.

FIELD NOTES

6 · Scouting: frames, project info, archive, PDF



PROJECT SETUP · SCOUT ARCHIVE

Project Setup

Open it from **Project Setup** at the top of the Exposure Wheel, the copper scene · shot button in the viewfinder, or **Archive › Project Setup**. Everything set here stays as it is until you change it here — switching modes or trying something in the viewfinder doesn't reset it.

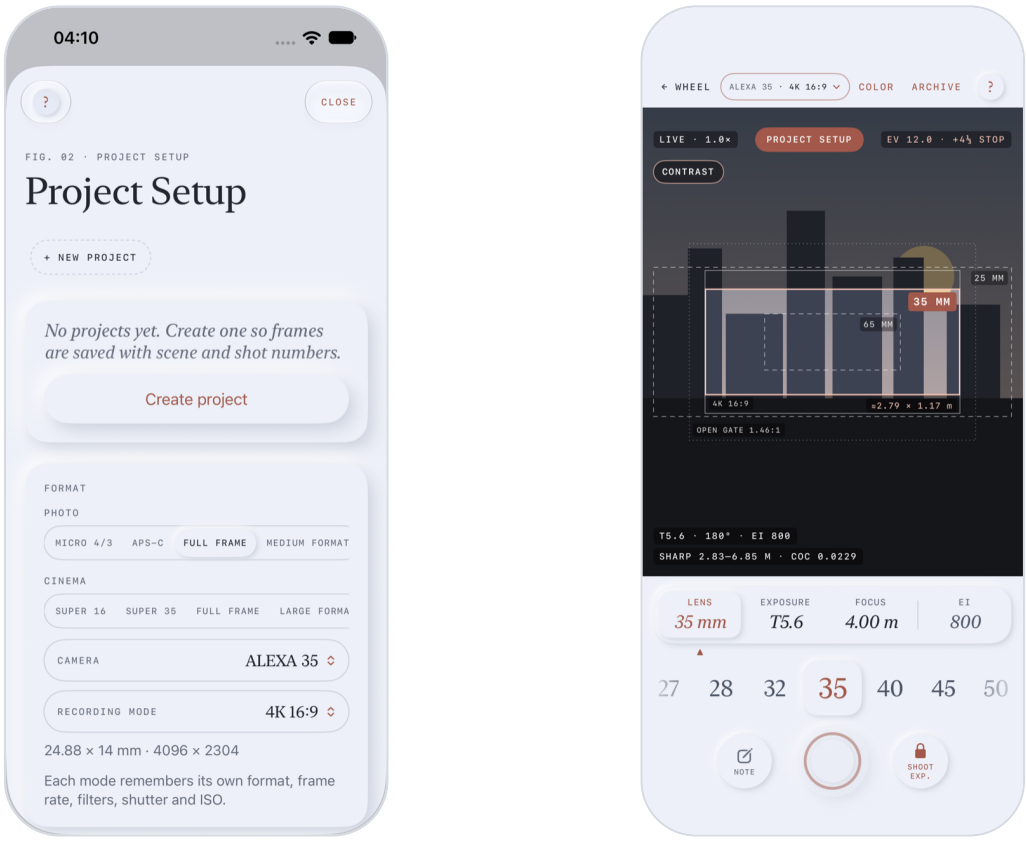
- **Projects** — tap a project to make it active; *+ New project* creates one. New frames go to the active project.
- **Today's shoot** — day, scene and shot counters with – / +; *Advance the shot number with each frame*.
- **Credits** — project name, director, cinematographer, production and shoot dates; they appear in the archive and on the PDF cover.
- **Delete project** — its frames stay in the archive.

Settings (in Project Setup)

- **Format** — the sensor format for Photo and for Cinema; each mode keeps its own.
- **Camera and recording mode** (Cinema only) — optional, under the Cinema formats. **Camera** starts at *None — generic format*, which keeps the formats above. Pick a camera — the menu is grouped by maker: **ARRI** (ALEXA 35 and 35 Xtreme, ALEXA Mini LF, ALEXA LF, ALEXA 65, ALEXA 265, ALEXA Mini, AMIRA, ALEXA SXT W), **Sony** (VENICE, VENICE 2 with 6K or 8.6K sensor, BURANO) and **RED** (V-RAPTOR 8K VV, V-RAPTOR [X] 8K VV, V-RAPTOR 8K S35, KOMODO 6K, KOMODO-X 6K); the long RED mode lists are split into sections by RED's menu groups or resolution. Sony FX9, FX6 and FX3 are not in the list because Sony does not publish their recording area sizes. Then pick its **Recording mode**: the frame, the aspect ratio placement, the angle of view, the frame size at the focus distance, the viewfinder frames and the circle of confusion (from the recording area's diagonal) then use that mode's recording area in millimeters, e.g. ALEXA 35 · 3.8K 2.39:1 = 23.325 × 9.77 mm. The format label in the viewfinder reads *ALEXA 35 · 3.8K 2.39:1*. When the recording area is smaller than the camera's open gate, the viewfinder draws both: the open gate dotted and the recording area as a thin solid line labeled with the mode. Anamorphic modes (ARRI Ana 2x, Sony anamorphic, RED 1.25×–2× modes) set the squeeze and it can't be changed; in the other modes your squeeze setting stays. A small ⓘ marks values that were worked out from the manufacturer's documents or confirmed by a single source. Picking a generic format, on the wheel or here, sets the camera back to None. Saved with the project; older projects open with None.
- **Kits — My kits** saves a camera and recording mode, an aspect ratio, up to two protect ratios and a lens pack under a name: add, edit, duplicate or delete; the star makes one kit the default (one at most; deleting it leaves no default). The **Kit** picker at the top of Project Setup (shown once you have a kit) fills those settings in; you can still change each one, and the kit itself stays as it is. If the settings differ from the kit, **Save to kit** or **Save as new kit** appear. A new project opens with the default kit. If a kit's camera or mode is no longer in the list, a note says so and that field is left empty. With no kits, everything works as before.
- **Frame** — aspect ratio, anamorphic squeeze and protect lines for the viewfinder and saved frames. With an active project it is also saved with the project and comes back when you pick that project again.
- **Distance unit** (m or ft) and **Distance measuring offset** (±100 cm; plus if the camera's sensor is behind the phone). It applies to LiDAR readings and to depth estimates.

- **Lens pack** — your own sets of lenses: tap **New lens pack**, give it a name and tap the focal lengths engraved on your lenses in the grid (tap again to remove one; the count shows above the grid). For a value not in the grid, tap **+ Custom mm** and enter it, with a decimal point or comma (52.3 or 52,3), 1–2000 mm; it joins the grid and can be removed the same way. Save needs a name and at least one lens. Each mode (Cinema, Photo) has its own choice; the first option, **All**, shows every lens as before. With a pack chosen, the wheel and the viewfinder list only its lenses, and **Custom…** stays available for any other value. If the selected lens is not in the new pack, the nearest focal length is chosen; a custom value you typed is kept. The choice is remembered and saved with the project. Tap a pack to edit it (its lenses come up selected) or delete it.
- **Circle of confusion** — the blur size depth of field is worked out with. There is no single standard: **ASC** (default) uses Super 35 0.025 mm and Super 16 0.015 mm; **Cooke** Super 35 0.025 mm and Super 16 0.0125 mm; for the other cinema formats (Full Frame, large format, 65 mm) both use 0.025 mm × format diagonal / 31.11 mm, the Super 35 diagonal; **Zeiss d/1500** is the format diagonal / 1500; **Custom** takes 0.005–0.1 mm. Photo formats have their own choice and never use the Super 35 scaling: **Zeiss d/1500** (default: format diagonal / 1500, about 0.029 mm on full frame; H. H. Nasse, “Depth of Field and Bokeh”, Carl Zeiss), **Canon** (full frame 0.035 mm, APS-C 0.019 mm; Canon Europe Pro, “Depth of field”; offered only for those two formats) or **Custom**; ASC and Cooke are cinema standards and are not offered there. For comparison, the 1982 Guild Kelly calculator used 0.0359 mm for 35 mm. The value in use is shown with its standard (“CoC 0.025 mm · ASC”, “CoC 0.0288 mm · Zeiss”). Saved with the project.
- **T–f difference** — 0, ⅒ or ⅓ stop (default 0). Cinema lenses are marked in T-stops, but depth of field depends on the f-number, which is a little smaller. Exposure (the wheel, EV, ND) always uses T. With a difference set, Cinema-mode depth of field and hyperfocal distance use f = T / 2^(difference/2) and are shown with ≈; at 0 they are worked out from T and the wheel notes that the real depth of field may be a little shallower.
- **Meter calibration** — ±3 stops in thirds. Meter the same scene with a light meter and the viewfinder and enter the difference.
- **Zone · SBR target** — the scene range the viewfinder’s Zone compares the brightest and darkest points with, in thirds of a stop (default 7), e.g. your camera’s usable dynamic range.
- **Compass correction** — ±45°.

- **Export** — add an info strip (project, scene/shot, format, aspect ratio, anamorphic and protect ratios, lens, exposure, depth of field) under frames saved to Photos, ending with CINEBRAIN PRO; **Draw protect lines on saved frames** (on by default); and **Frames per page** for scout reports (1 or 2).
- **CineBrain Pro** — whether Pro is active; opens the Pro screen (buy, restore purchases).
- **Introduction** — watch the introduction again, show the tips again, or open this guide.



PROJECT SETUP › CAMERA AND RECORDING MODE · VIEWFINDER: ALEXA 35 4K 16:9 WITH A 2.39 FRAME

Scout Archive

Open it with **Archive** in the viewfinder. Frames are grouped by project (the active one first), then by day and scene, with the frame and shot number under each thumbnail (*FRAME 7 · SHOT 3*). Tap a frame for its details; touch and hold to delete it. The star in a thumbnail's corner (and in the frame details) marks the frame for the PDF.

The frame number is given when you press the shutter and never changes: deleting a frame doesn't renumber the others, and a deleted number is not used again; the next frame gets the next number. Frames saved before frame numbers existed were numbered once, in archive order. The frame details show the number in the title.

Frame details

The saved frame, each detail in its own box (format and aspect ratio separately), the Light Plan, the location visual and a note field that saves itself.

Location visual

Three pictures of the place can go into the PDF, to the left of the light times:

- **Sketch — Add sketch**: take a photo of a hand-drawn plan or pick one from Photos (the system picker hands over only the photo you choose; no photo library access is asked). **Replace sketch** and **Delete sketch** change it.
- **Map** — only with **Satellite map** turned on in Project Setup (off by default; the first time, a note explains that the frame's location is sent to Apple Maps): when a frame has a location and the iPhone is online, a satellite image of about 150 m around the camera (north up) is saved with the frame, so the PDF can be made offline later. On it: the camera (copper dot), the lens's field of view as a cone, the sun's direction for each hour from sunrise to sunset with the hour, the sun's direction when the frame was saved, and a 50 m scale. If there was no connection, **Get the map** in the frame details fetches it (shown only while the setting is on). Maps already saved stay with their frames when you turn it off. The Apple Maps logo stays on the image.
- **Sun diagram** — the sun's path that day seen from above, hour marks, the frame's field of view and the sun at the frame time.

Show in the PDF picks one; without a choice the order is sketch, map, sun diagram. A portrait sketch keeps its proportions. The light times list stays in every case.

Voice notes

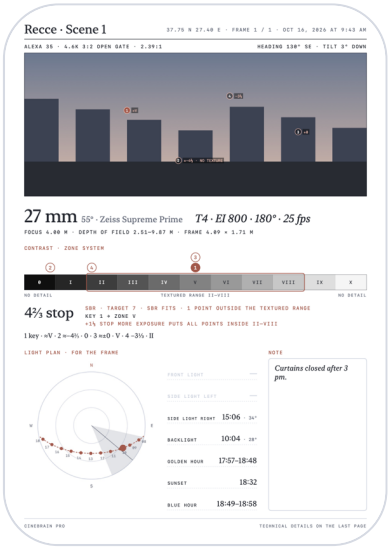
Next to **Note** there is a microphone. Touch and hold it, speak, and release: what you said is added to the end of the note. The same note card opens from the **Note** button beside the viewfinder's shutter, for the last saved frame. Notes are recognized in the app's language (English or Turkish), on your iPhone only: the sound is not recorded and nothing is sent anywhere. The first time, the app asks for Microphone and Speech Recognition access; hold the button again once you have allowed it. If your iPhone cannot recognize the app's language on the device, the microphone is not shown and you type the note.

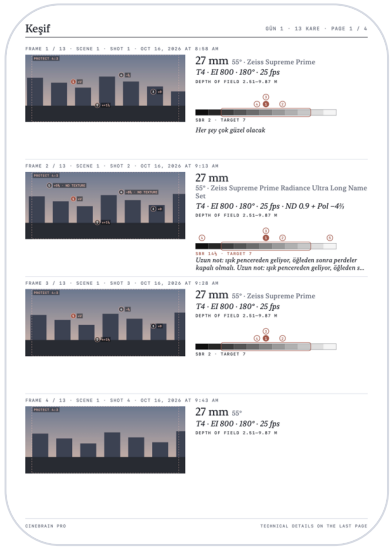
PDF scout report

PDF makes a report for the whole project, **Day PDF** for one day. Pick the **PDF type**, choose whether to **Add technical appendix** (on by default) and tap **Make PDF**; the share sheet sends it where you like. Under **Frames in the PDF** choose **All**, **Starred** or

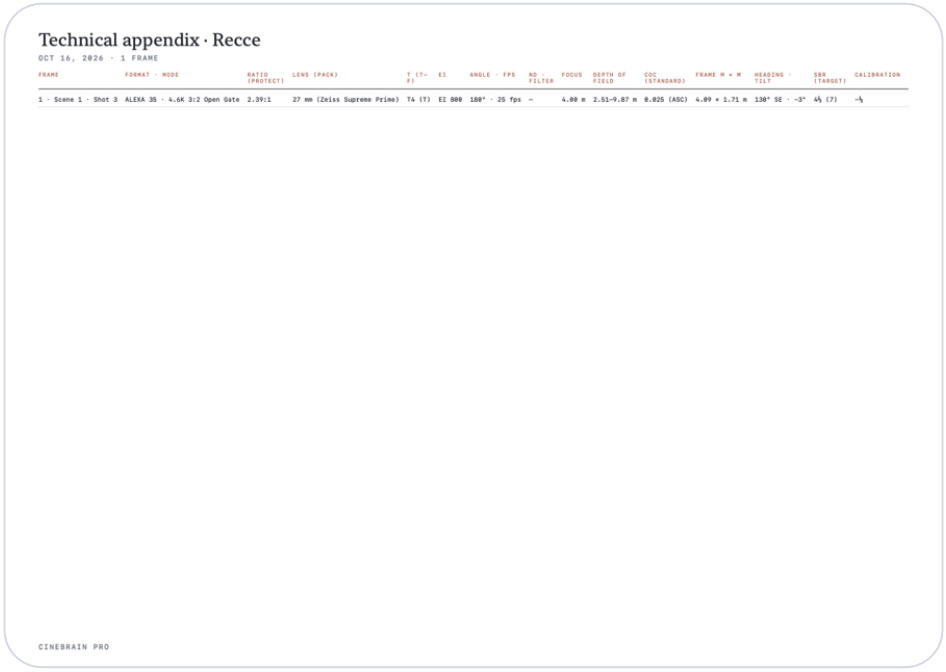
Selected (tap frames to pick them; it starts with the starred ones). Frames you leave out are not in the PDF, and the others keep their frame numbers: a page says *FRAME 7*, separately from the page count (*3 / 8*). Your choices are remembered; the PDF type can also be set in Project Setup › Export. PDFs are made on the iPhone, with no internet; texts follow the app's language.

- **Scout plan** (A4 portrait, one frame per page) — project · scene, location coordinates, frame number and date; camera · mode · ratio (or format · ratio) and heading · tilt; the large frame with its numbered Zone points and protect labels; the lens in large type with the horizontal angle and the lens pack name, next to aperture or T-stop, EI, shutter and filters (a long line moves down rather than being cut); focus, depth of field and frame size. If the frame has Zone points, a **ZONE SYSTEM** section (with "contrast range" under the title and the exposure the Zones refer to, e.g. *Zones at T2 · EI 800 · 180° · 25 fps · ND 0.9*): a Zone strip 0–X with the textured range II–VIII outlined, the points at their zones (the key filled), the SBR against the target and the key's zone, and the point list. Below, the light plan for the frame — the location visual (sketch, map or sun diagram) beside the light times (front, side left, side right, backlight, golden hour, sunset, blue hour; a missing moment shows a faint "—") — and a note box.
- **Frame list** (A4 portrait, four frames per page) — each frame with lens, pack and angle, exposure, depth of field, a small Zone strip and SBR when the frame has Zone points, and two lines of the note.
- **Technical appendix** — a table at the end (landscape pages), one row per frame: frame, format · mode, ratio (protect), lens (pack), T (T–f difference), EI, angle · fps, ND · filter, focus, depth of field, CoC (standard), frame size, heading · tilt, SBR (target) and calibration.





SCOUT PLAN · FRAME LIST



Technical appendix · Recce

OCT 16, 2026 · 1 FRAME

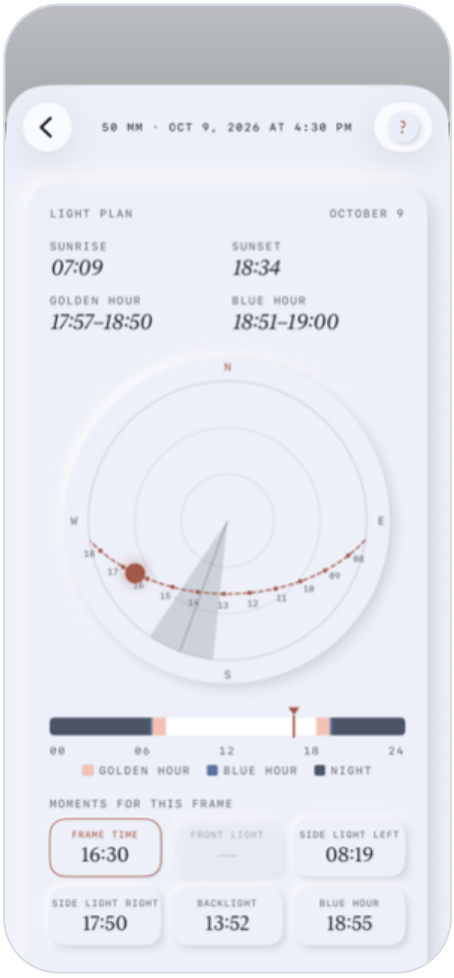
FRAME	FORMAT · MODE	RATIO (PROTECT)	LENS (PACK)	T (T– F)	EI	ANGLE · FPS	ND · FILTER	FOCUS	DEPTH OF FIELD	COC (STANDARD)	FRAME W × H	HEADING · TILT	SBR (TARGET)	CALIBRATION
1 · Scene 1 · Shot 3	ALEXA 35 · 4.6K 3:2 Open Gate	2.39:1	27 mm (Zeiss Supreme Prime)	T4 (T)	EI 800	180° · 25 fps	–	4.00 m	2.51–9.87 m	0.025 (ASC)	4.09 × 1.71 m	130° SE · −3°	⅛ (7)	–

CINEBRAIN PRO

TECHNICAL APPENDIX

FIELD NOTES

7 · Light Plan



FRAME DETAILS · LIGHT PLAN

Every frame saved with a location has a light plan for that day and place, calculated on the phone (NOAA solar formulas).

- **Sunrise, sunset, golden hour** (sun between −4° and 6°) and **blue hour** (−6° to −4°); evening times are shown.
- **Sun dial** — north up, overhead in the center, horizon at the edge. The dashed copper line is the sun's path with hours; the grey wedge is the frame's direction, as wide as the lens's angle of view.
- **Day line** — night, blue hour, golden hour and day. Drag along it to pick a time.
- **Moments for this frame** — Frame time, Front light, Side light left and right, Backlight and Blue Hour. For the four directional moments the target sun direction is the camera heading + 180° (front), − 90° (side left), + 90° (side right) and the heading itself (backlight); every minute with the sun above the horizon is scanned

and the one where the sun's azimuth is closest to the target is chosen, shown with the sun's height (e.g. *15:06 · 34°*). If the closest is more than 45° away, it shows "—". Tap a moment to set the dial to it.

For the chosen time you see the sun's direction and height, where it is relative to the frame, an estimated light level (a rough EV for a clear sky) and suggested settings: in Cinema the angle, frame rate and EI stay and the ND (then the T-stop) changes; in Photo the ISO and filters stay. For backlight it suggests opening about one stop for faces. **Set the wheel to this time** loads that light, lens, format and settings into the Exposure Wheel (the scene light becomes Manual).

Moments that depend on direction need the compass heading of the frame.

FIELD NOTES

8 · Questions and limits

Does it need the internet?

No. The app does not connect to the internet; only if you turn on the satellite map setting (Project Setup › Satellite map, off by default), a frame's location is sent to Apple for the map image. Everything else, including the sun calculations and the PDF, runs on the iPhone.

Where are my frames?

In the app on your iPhone, and in Photos if saving there worked. They are part of your device backups. Deleting the app deletes its archive.

How accurate is the meter?

The reading comes from the iPhone camera's own exposure and can differ slightly from a light meter. Compare once and enter the difference in Meter calibration.

How accurate is the color reading?

Approximate. Use a color meter for critical work. If green light (fluorescent) suggests Plus instead of Minus Green, please tell us.

LiDAR and estimated distance

LiDAR (Pro models) measures up to about 5 m. LiDAR on LiDAR models; an approximate estimate from depth on dual-camera models; manual entry on other models. Estimates are marked ≈:

- **Depth** — iPhones with two rear cameras compare the two pictures. Best on a detailed surface within a few meters; plain walls, glass and dark scenes are hard.

LiDAR and depth measuring pause the preview for a moment. If an estimate is off by the same amount every time, set the Distance measuring offset to correct it. The frame's details show how its distance was found (*Distance measured*); a distance you set by hand is not marked.

Compass and sun marker

The iPhone compass is usually within 5–10° and can be disturbed by metal nearby; use Align or Compass correction. The sun marker needs location.

The viewfinder frame

Choose the ratio by tapping the format label; 2.39:1 is the default. Anamorphic lenses see wider by their squeeze, so they reach “Wider” sooner. Lenses wider than the phone’s ultra-wide camera show “Wider”; very long lenses use digital zoom.

Frames without a light plan

Frames saved without location (or before the app had location access) have no light plan; frames without a compass heading have no direction-based moments.

Frames in Photos

The app asks only to add photos and never reads your library. Saved frames are added to your library, not to an album; you can put them in an album yourself in Photos.

FIELD NOTES

CONTACT · SUPPORT

Questions and support

support@cinebrain.app

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